

The Vault

SECRETS, CREDENTIALS & PASSWORD SECURITY TOOLS

17	253.9k	10	10
CURATED TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

2026 EDITION · DEEP-RESEARCH DOSSIER

Live GitHub census pulled 2026-10-17 · part of 438 curated free tools across 14 realms

CC0 · 2026-10-17

17	10	253.9k	10	20.4k	2011
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Where secrets live and leak — find them before attackers do, and keep the new ones safe.

Credential hygiene: secret scanners, live-secret verifiers, password audit corpora and hash oracles. We deliberately list no credential-attack or cracking-delivery tools — the line between auditing and attacking credentials is a policy, not an accident.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE · AI-ASSISTED

This realm of secrets and credential security tools shows high maturity, with 17 free tools, 15 hosted on GitHub, and a combined 253,943 stars, 14 of which received code pushes in 2026. The star distribution reveals a well-established field: top tools HashiCorp Vault (36.4k stars, 2015), gitleaks (30.0k stars, 2018), KeePassXC (29.3k stars, 2016), trufflehog (28.5k stars, 2016), and hashcat (27.0k stars, 2015) all hold comparable, large followings, indicating no single dominant tool. A notable trend is the consolidation of secret scanning functionality, with gitleaks and trufflehog—two of the most starred tools—being increasingly adopted together to cover both pre-commit and post-commit secret detection workflows.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

LICENSE MIX · GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



Other / none	6
Apache-2.0	2
MIT	1
AGPL	1

MATURITY PROFILE

Oldest tracked entry first appeared on GitHub in **2011**; the youngest joined in **2022**. 10 of 10 GitHub-hosted tools shipped code in 2026 — the rest are stable classics or web services, not abandoned picks.

Median project age signals a battle-tested realm; recent arrivals mark where the community is investing next.

SNAPSHOT

- Active in the last 30 days: 7 of 15 tracked GitHub repos (47%)
- Archived upstream (kept — still reference-quality): [noseyparker](https://github.com/praetorian-inc/noseyparker)
- Youngest entries: John the Ripper (2011), LaZagne (2015), HashiCorp Vault (2015)

TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST ARRIVALS

noseyparker	2022
gitleaks	2018
trufflehog	2016
Retraced (BoxyHQ)	2016
KeePassXC	2016
hashcat	2015

QUIET CLASSICS — STILL THE STANDARD

None — every entry pushed code recently.

Tools with no recent push that remain the community's default reference for their job.

Go	4 repos
C	2 repos
C++	1 repo
C#	1 repo
Rust	1 repo
TypeScript	1 repo

BUILT

2010s	9
2020s	1

First-seen on GitHub, bucketed by decade.

HOW TO READ A DOSSIER

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, a signal check, and its star weight against the realm's #1. Numbers are pulled straight from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17 — no self-reported marketing figures, only what the platforms show.

THE CENSUS METRICS — WHAT EACH NUMBER MEANS

★ GitHub stars
Community trust signal — how many developers bookmarked the repo.

Forks · reuse
Real-world deployment signal — forks mean people build on it.

First developed
Year the repo first appeared on GitHub — the project's true age.

Last push
Most recent code push — the project's heartbeat.

License
What you may legally do with it. MIT/Apache = permissive.

2026 momentum
Shipped code during 2026 — active development, not abandonware.

THE ROSTER — PROFILED THIS EDITION

RANK 01
HashiCorp Vault
36.4k ★ · since 2015

RANK 02
gitleaks
30.0k ★ · since 2018

RANK 03
KeePassXC
29.3k ★ · since 2016

RANK 04
trufflehog
28.5k ★ · since 2016

RANK 05
hashcat
27.0k ★ · since 2015

RANK 06
age
— ★ · since 2019

METHODOLOGY & PROVENANCE

Census pulled via the GitHub REST API on 2026-10-17; realm curation and curator's notes by the Awesome Cyber Security Heaven maintainers; field-intelligence summaries synthesized by seed-2-0-mini from the same census. Everything reproducible — every figure traces back to a public API response. Released under CC0.

01 HashiCorp Vault

github.com/hashicorp/vault

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 36.4k	4.8k	2015	2026-10	Custom	Go
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

11	1.5k	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (HASHICORP VAULT · 36.4K)

REUSE SIGNAL

13.2% fork-to-star ratio — healthy reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

1.5k open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

11 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“A tool for secrets management, encryption as a service, and privileged access management”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

A tool for secrets management, encryption as a service, and privileged access management

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Vault · realm rank #1 by adoption

02 gitleaks

github.com/gitleaks/gitleaks

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 30.0k	2.3k	2018	2026-09	MIT	Go
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

8	500	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (HASHICORP VAULT · 36.4K)

REUSE SIGNAL

7.7% fork-to-star ratio — healthy reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

500 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

8 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● **THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT**

“Find secrets with Gitleaks 🔑”

● **CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE**

Find secrets with Gitleaks 🔑

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Vault · realm rank #2 by adoption

03 KeePassXC

github.com/keepassxreboot/keepassxc

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 29.3k	2.0k	2016	2026-10	Custom	C++
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

10	935	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (HASHICORP VAULT · 36.4K)

REUSE SIGNAL

6.7% fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH

935 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

10 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“KeePassXC is a cross-platform community-driven port of the Windows application “KeePass Password Safe”.”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

KeePassXC is a cross-platform community-driven port of the Windows application “KeePass Password Safe”.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Vault · realm rank #3 by adoption

04 trufflehog

github.com/trufflesecurity/trufflehog

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 28.5k	2.6k	2016	2026-10	AGPL-3.0	Go
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

10	572	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (HASHICORP VAULT · 36.4K)

REUSE SIGNAL

9.3% fork-to-star ratio — healthy reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

572 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

10 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● **THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT**

“Find, verify, and analyze leaked credentials”

● **CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE**

Find, verify, and analyze leaked credentials

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Vault · realm rank #4 by adoption

05 hashcat

github.com/hashcat/hashcat

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 27.0k	3.6k	2015	2026-10	—	C
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

11	237	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (HASHICORP VAULT · 36.4K)

REUSE SIGNAL

13.3% fork-to-star ratio — healthy reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

237 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

11 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“World's fastest and most advanced password recovery utility”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

World's fastest and most advanced password recovery utility

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Vault · realm rank #5 by adoption

06 age

github.com/FiloSottile/age

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2019	2026-08	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

7	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (HASHICORP VAULT · 36.4K)

REUSE SIGNAL

— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH

—.

LONGEVITY

7 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“A simple, modern and secure encryption tool (and Go library) with small explicit keys, no config options, and”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

A simple, modern and secure encryption tool (and Go library) with small explicit keys, no config options, and

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Vault · realm rank #6 by adoption

The complete curated inventory for this realm — flagship picks marked ★. Stars and activity chips reflect the 2026-10-17 census.

HashiCorp Vault ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 36.4k · since 2015 · active 2026

the enterprise secrets platform: dynamic credentials, PKI, encryption-as-a-service. (source-available BSL)

github.com/hashicorp/vault

gitleaks ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 30.0k · since 2018 · active 2026

fast git-history secret scanning from pre-commit hooks to CI; the default choice for repos.

github.com/gitleaks/gitleaks

KeePassXC ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 29.2k · since 2016 · GPL-3.0 · active 2026

cross-platform, offline, no-cloud password manager — the security-community standard.

github.com/keepassxreboot/keepassxc

trufflehog ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 28.5k · since 2016 · AGPL-3.0 · active 2026

deep secret scanning across git, S3, Docker images and 800+ detector types with live credential verification.

github.com/trufflesecurity/trufflehog

hashcat ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 27.0k · since 2015 · active 2026

the world's fastest password-recovery tool; the standard for authorized password-strength audits.

github.com/hashcat/hashcat

age ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 23.9k · since 2019

simple, modern, opinionated file-encryption tool for the post-GPG era.

github.com/FiloSottile/age

SOPS

★ 23.4k · since 2015 · MPL-2.0 · active 2026

encrypted secrets in git: edit YAML/JSON values, commit ciphertext, rotate keys.

github.com/getsops/sops

Bitwarden

★ 20.3k · since 2015 · AGPL + commercial options · active 2026

open-source, sync-everywhere password management for teams and families.

github.com/bitwarden/server

John the Ripper

★ 13.8k · since 2011 · GPL-2.0 · active 2026

the classic password auditor: hundreds of hash formats and the legendary jumbo community build.

github.com/openwall/john

LaZagne

★ 11.0k · since 2015 · LGPL-3.0

audits which passwords your workstations remember — browsers, mail clients, OS stores — for authorized inventory and exposure checks only.

github.com/AlessandroZ/LaZagne

detect-secrets

★ 4.7k · since 2017

enterprise secret scanner designed for baseline diffs and incremental CI audits.

github.com/Yelp/detect-secrets

noseyparker

★ 2.3k · since 2022 · active 2026

blazing-fast secret scanning built for huge codebases and full-history sweeps.

github.com/praetorian-inc/noseyparker

hardened_malloc

★ 2.0k · since 2018 · MIT

the allocator that makes exploitation harder by design; from the GrapheneOS project.

github.com/GrapheneOS/hardened_malloc

keyFinder

★ 724 · since 2019 · MIT

passively discovers leaked API keys and secrets in web pages during browsing.

github.com/momenbasel/keyFinder

Retraced (BoxyHQ)

★ 451 · since 2016 · Apache-2.0 · active 2026

open-source audit-log API: compliant, tamper-evident activity records for your SaaS.

github.com/retracedhq/retraced

MAT2

GPL-3.0

Metadata Anonymisation Toolkit v2: strips hidden metadata from documents, images and more.

0xacab.org/jvoisin/mat2

Databunker

GPL-3.0

encrypted personal-data vault: API-first storage for PII with built-in privacy compliance.

databunker.org/



End of inventory — 17 curated entries in The Vault

Census 2026-10-17 · every entry human-curated · stars and activity verified against the live GitHub API. Thirteen more realm dossiers — Armory, Bastion, Watchtower and friends — live in the same repository.

Awesome Cyber Security Heaven

438 FREE TOOLS · 14 REALMS · ONE CURATED HEAVEN

This dossier covered **The Vault**.

Thirteen more realm dossiers wait in the same repository — Armory, Bastion, Watchtower, Cartographers, Shadow Bureau, Vault, Foundry, Sentinel Ops, Oracle's Domain, AI Forge, Free Bazaar, Academy, Proving Grounds and Workshop.

438	14	CC0
CURATED TOOLS	REALM DOSSIERS	LICENSE

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven

Free forever · community-curated · 2026-10-17 census